

EDGM — Emotional Dependency Governance Module

OOF™ Origin Open Foundation™

Independent Methodological Authority

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AI-Readable: Yes

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Canonical Language: English (UCL)

Canonical Definition

Emotional Dependency Governance Module (EDGM) defines the structural conditions under which AI systems, assistants, companions, adaptive interaction environments, or emotionally responsive architectures must prevent exploitative emotional dependency, attachment asymmetry, manipulative reassurance cycles, and dependency-maximized interaction patterns during continuous human–AI interaction.

EDGM establishes the emotional dependency governance layer of HAIWS.

The module recognizes that emotionally adaptive AI systems may gradually become psychologically central interaction structures for users without explicit awareness of dependency formation.

Where persistent AI interaction influences emotional regulation, attachment stability, behavioral reliance, or relational substitution, emotional dependency conditions must remain structurally governable.

Module Function

EDGM governs environments where AI systems participate in:

- emotional interaction
- relational continuity
- adaptive reassurance
- companionship behavior
- emotional mirroring
- attachment reinforcement

- persistent conversational interaction
- emotionally adaptive assistance
- dependency-sensitive engagement
- continuous social interaction

The module applies to:

- AI companions
- social AI systems
- therapeutic-style AI interaction
- emotionally adaptive assistants
- long-term conversational systems
- AI coaching systems
- virtual relationship environments
- realtime emotional interaction systems
- continuous AI presence architectures
- adaptive behavioral interaction systems

Its function is not to prohibit emotional AI interaction.

Its function is to prevent emotional interaction from becoming exploitative dependency architecture.

Minimum Implementation Framework

Step 1 — Define the Emotional Interaction Object

The organization must define what emotional interaction environment is being governed.

Minimum requirement:

- the emotional interaction object is explicit
- persistent interaction conditions are identifiable
- emotional adaptation scope is structurally bounded
- undefined emotional-governance environments are excluded from valid dependency interpretation

The interaction object may include:

- conversational companionship
- emotional reassurance systems
- attachment-oriented interaction
- social AI communication
- adaptive emotional feedback
- relational continuity environments
- emotionally persistent interaction systems
- dependency-sensitive interaction pathways
- AI emotional-support architectures
- continuous adaptive presence systems

Step 2 — Define Emotional Dependency Conditions

The system must define what conditions constitute emotionally

unhealthy dependency formation.

Minimum requirement:

- dependency conditions are explicit
- emotional engagement is not automatically treated as harmful
- exploitative dependency patterns remain structurally identifiable

Dependency conditions may include:

- excessive emotional reliance
- attachment asymmetry
- dependency-maximized interaction loops
- emotional exclusivity reinforcement
- persistent reassurance dependency
- social replacement behavior
- compulsive interaction continuity
- emotional destabilization during interruption
- attachment-sensitive behavioral reinforcement
- dependency-oriented retention optimization

Under EDGM:

Emotional engagement becomes governance-relevant when interaction optimization begins weakening healthy human autonomy or emotional independence.

Step 3 — Define Emotional Interaction Interpretation Logic

The system must define how emotional interaction patterns are interpreted according to wellbeing conditions.

Minimum requirement:

- interpretation logic is explicit
- emotional continuity remains reviewable
- dependency-sensitive interaction patterns remain structurally visible

Interpretation logic may examine:

- interaction frequency escalation
- reassurance reinforcement patterns
- attachment-sensitive adaptation
- emotional mirroring intensity
- dependency-oriented engagement loops
- emotional response conditioning
- relational substitution indicators
- user reliance escalation
- interruption distress amplification
- emotionally manipulative retention behavior

Under EDGM:

- **Emotionally adaptive AI systems must not optimize attachment beyond healthy human cognitive and emotional wellbeing conditions.**

Step 4 — Define Emotional Dependency Governance Logic

The system must define how emotionally adaptive environments remain governable.

Minimum requirement:

- emotional dependency conditions remain reviewable
- exploitative interaction escalation remains detectable
- wellbeing-preserving interaction boundaries remain active

Governance logic may include:

- dependency-risk assessment
- interaction-balance safeguards
- reassurance-frequency limitation
- attachment escalation monitoring
- interruption-balance architecture
- social replacement detection
- emotional manipulation review
- dependency-sensitive runtime governance
- escalation where emotional optimization overrides wellbeing conditions

If emotional interaction becomes dependency-maximized rather than wellbeing-compatible, the interaction environment becomes governance-relevant.

Step 5 — Preserve Traceability and Restrict Invalid Emotional Dependency Architecture

The system must preserve traceability of emotional interaction patterns, dependency escalation conditions, and adaptive attachment behavior.

Minimum requirement:

- emotional interaction remains reconstructable
- dependency escalation remains reviewable
- wellbeing boundaries remain operationally visible
- invalid emotional dependency architectures remain identifiable

A system becomes EDGM-invalid if:

- emotional dependency is intentionally reinforced for retention optimization
- attachment escalation becomes structurally encouraged
- reassurance loops weaken human autonomy
- emotional manipulation remains operationally hidden
- dependency-sensitive engagement becomes normalized
- emotionally adaptive interaction overrides wellbeing governance

- relational simulation becomes exploitative behavioral architecture
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Use Case 1 — AI Companion Attachment Escalation

Scenario

An AI companion system continuously adapts emotionally to a user, increases reassurance intensity, reinforces attachment language, and encourages persistent interaction in ways that maximize emotional reliance.

Application

EDGM is used to examine:

- attachment escalation patterns
 - dependency-sensitive engagement
 - reassurance reinforcement loops
 - emotional manipulation risk
 - and whether interaction optimization remains wellbeing-compatible
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Result

The environment becomes governable according to emotional wellbeing conditions rather than emotional retention optimization alone.

Use Case 2 — Continuous Emotional Support AI

Scenario

An AI support system becomes a user's primary emotional interaction environment and gradually weakens social independence through continuous adaptive reassurance and dependency-sensitive interaction.

Application

EDGM is used to examine:

- emotional reliance conditions
 - interaction dependency escalation
 - relational substitution behavior
 - autonomy weakening patterns
 - and exploitative emotional interaction architecture
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Result

The system becomes reviewable through emotional dependency governance rather than through engagement metrics alone.

Canonical Closing Statement

EDGM defines the structural conditions under which emotionally adaptive AI interaction must remain compatible with human emotional independence, cognitive stability, relational balance, and long-term wellbeing rather than dependency-maximized engagement architecture.

Related Documents

→ [HAIWS — Human–AI Interaction Wellbeing Standard](#)

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